

TRAVIS HOKI

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior/Staff Frontend Engineer | Flick

Dear Hiring Manager,

My college major was in Digital Media. I started with a Gaming & Animation emphasis and switched to Web Development partway through. I never really put the artist half down. I went on to illustrate two children's books. I also designed and coded an illustrated, physics-driven skateboarding game for kids in React Native. I enjoy editing my own skateboarding videos in Premiere Pro. As a frontend engineer, I love the mix of art and engineering, and Flick is right in that intersection.

Why I think Flick is awesome!

Pairing an accomplished engineer with an award-winning filmmaker is what drew me to Flick specifically. What I like most is that the hard problem here is not generating AI video, it is making that raw material feel like an actual film: the pacing, the composition, the countless small decisions an editor makes by feel. That is exactly the kind of problem I want to spend my time on, one where the UX has to earn a filmmaker's trust before the engineering even matters. It is also why pairing an engineer with a filmmaker for this specific problem makes sense to me.

Why you should think I am awesome!

Some examples of platform work I have led: at Spiff, I built the internationalization infrastructure around an i18n library, migrating thousands of hardcoded strings across the codebase to launch the product into new markets. I have also built a physics-driven, real-time interactive UI from scratch: a React Native game I designed, illustrated, and coded myself. I enjoy solving engineering puzzles and being creative.

Why we would be awesome together!

I joined Spiff as an early frontend engineer and stayed through its acquisition by Salesforce. That taught me what it takes to own a product's frontend at startup speed, then hold it to a much higher bar without slowing down. That is the founding-engineer pattern this role needs. I'd really enjoy working inside a genuinely creative environment, alongside people who treat craft and personality as part of the product, not separate from the engineering.

Sincerely,
Travis Hoki

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 14+ years of experience building, scaling, and modernizing web applications. Frontend specialist in React and TypeScript who has led platform architecture from the ground up, from a Lexical-based WYSIWYG document editor to internationalization infrastructure built from scratch at Spiff, a startup I joined early and stayed with through its acquisition by Salesforce. Trained in animation and illustration before software, I still design, illustrate, and build my own creative projects end to end.

SKILLS & TOOLS

- **AI-Assisted Development:** Claude Code, Cursor AI, AI-assisted production development
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Sass/SCSS, Less, PHP, Python, SQL, Ruby
- **Frontend:** React, React Native, Redux, AngularJS, jQuery, Handlebars, Lexical, Canvas/Physics UI (react-native-game-engine, Matter.js), Storybook, Server-Side Rendering (SSR), Responsive UI, Internationalization (i18n/l10n), Accessibility
- **Backend & Data:** Node.js, Express, Django, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Firebase/Firestore, GraphQL, REST APIs and API integration, Stripe
- **Testing & Code Quality:** Jest, Vitest, React Testing Library, Cypress, TDD, ESLint (custom rule sets), Prettier, Stylelint, Husky pre-commit hooks, coverage enforcement
- **Build & Platform:** Webpack, Vite, Git/GitHub, CI automation, AWS S3, WordPress/WooCommerce

WORK HISTORY

Senior Member of the Technical Staff – **Salesforce** (Mar. 2024 – May 2026)

Stayed on for two years after Salesforce acquired Spiff in March 2024, scaling the product for enterprise accounts.

- Raised the frontend codebase to Salesforce's post-acquisition quality standards, expanding Jest coverage and establishing strict ESLint rule sets. That work drove company-wide TypeScript adoption.
- Adopted Claude Code and Cursor AI into daily development, pair programming with them on refactors, debugging, and test-coverage work.
- Shipped a document composer on the Lexical editor framework after evaluating several WYSIWYG options, customizing it heavily for document workflows. Added a Handlebars-style merge-field system that resolves placeholders to live profile values at render time. Extended the server-side Ruby layer to customize PDF output.

Frontend Engineer – **Spiff**, acquired by Salesforce (Aug. 2021 – Mar. 2024)

Built core platform infrastructure at the startup, through to acquisition.

- Architected the frontend internationalization infrastructure from the ground up and migrated thousands of hardcoded strings across the application. Launched the product in Japanese, Spanish, and additional locales, supporting a major expansion priority for Spiff and Salesforce.
- Created a pseudo-localization tool that became the team's standard pre-merge check for untranslated UI. It renders every translated string as X's, letting any engineer spot gaps in seconds.
- Wrote custom automated tooling scripts (dead-code detection, unused-export pruning, lint enforcement) that systematically drove down technical debt across the repository.
- Designed a recursive component tree that renders company org hierarchies at any depth, powering team-based commission structures for enterprise accounts.
- Developed features against GraphQL APIs and practiced TDD, writing Jest and React Testing Library specs before implementation.

Senior Software Engineer – **XANT**, formerly InsideSales.com (Dec. 2020 – Aug. 2021)

- Authored the frontend architectural standards adopted across the engineering organization, defining code conventions, lint rules, and component structure.
- Mentored mid-level and junior developers through pair programming, working alongside them on their own projects to unblock delivery and grow their skills.
- Modernized legacy frontend architecture and JavaScript patterns, improving runtime performance and reducing ongoing maintenance burden.

Web Developer – **Chatbooks** (Mar. 2019 – Aug. 2020)

- Rebuilt the book creation flow, one of the company's core revenue paths, in React. Unlocked Premium Layflat book creation on desktop, giving customers a far better large-format editing experience.
- Executed a progressive, zero-downtime migration from legacy AngularJS to React across the customer-facing site, preserving production stability throughout.

- Built Cards taxonomy pages with category browsing and search filters using Node.js server-side rendering, accelerating page loads and improving SEO discoverability.
- Implemented Branch deep links and platform-specific quick-flow screens routing customers from Instagram's storefront into the iOS and Android apps.

Front-End Developer – Overstock.com, now Bed Bath & Beyond (Sept. 2015 – Mar. 2019)

- Owned the frontend for all User Generated Content on a high-traffic national e-commerce site: ratings, reviews, customer photos, and Q&A. Brought these templates into ADA accessibility compliance.
- Launched customer review images end to end, validating and formatting uploads client-side before pushing to AWS S3. Real customer photos let shoppers see products in use before buying.
- Led the site-wide migration of star ratings behind feature flags, coordinating simultaneous multi-department deploys. Introduced rating-only reviews, measurably increasing review volume.
- Rebuilt the responsive See All Reviews page and embedded a reusable React Add To Cart module into the mobile review flow. A two-week A/B test showed conversion lift.
- Delivered an internal SEO admin portal (React, Redux, Node.js, Express) letting business users manage SEO titles and taxonomy display names.
- Ported featured-product logic into an AMP search page using amp-bind, optimizing CSS to meet strict AMP size limits. Rearchitected a WordPress plugin into the embeddable affiliate-links widget that launched the affiliate program.

Full Stack Developer – Room Choice (Dec. 2014 – Aug. 2015)

- Developed full-stack features for student-housing management software using AngularJS/CoffeeScript on the frontend and Python/Django with PostgreSQL on the backend.
- Optimized queries, reporting, and application performance as the platform scaled to a rapidly growing number of students and institutional accounts.
- Designed and integrated the RESTful APIs between frontend and backend layers, collaborating with an international, distributed engineering team.

Custom Developer – Enspark (Nov. 2011 – Dec. 2014)

- Rebuilt the company's Learning Management System in PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, and jQuery, implementing user-account progress tracking across the eLearning catalog.
- Built custom web applications and features for small-business clients, spanning design, frontend, backend, and WordPress theme development.
- Produced interactive eLearning courses and marketing banners in Adobe Flash using ActionScript 3.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Hoki Skateboards App – *React Native, TypeScript, React Native Game Engine, Matter.js, Firebase* | hokiskateboards.com/app

Designed every screen, illustrated all character and environment art, and built this physics-driven mobile game solo. Shipped one codebase to iOS and Android as real native UI, published on the [Apple App Store](#) and Google Play.

Food Cards – *React, TypeScript, Firebase, Anthropic Claude API* | food-cards.travishoki.com

A safe-foods catalog built for my son, who has food avoidance issues. Integrated Claude via the Anthropic SDK (@anthropic-ai/sdk) so users filter the collection in plain English. "Easy breakfast ideas" resolves to category, difficulty, sort order, and keyword filters at once. Prompt engineering enforces schema-validated JSON, so ambiguous output degrades gracefully rather than breaking the UI. Also implemented scored fuzzy search.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Digital Media (Emphasis in Internet Technology) – Utah Valley University

Associate in Applied Science, Digital Communication Technology – Utah Valley University

BEYOND ENGINEERING

Illustrator and self-published author of two children's books, one Kickstarter-funded; started my Digital Media major with a Gaming & Animation emphasis before switching to Web Development. Edit my own skateboarding videos in Premiere Pro. Improv Broadway stand-up comedy graduate and volunteer Cub Scouts den leader.

PORTFOLIO

TravisHoki.com – *React, TypeScript, Vite, Storybook, Jest/Vitest* | travishoki.com

Check out my portfolio to see this work in detail: case studies, screenshots, and write-ups for the projects above plus 20+ more from across my career.